

Negative Keyword Checklist

Amazon VA Interview Lab

When to Add Negative Keywords

- Search term is irrelevant to your product
- Search term has high clicks and zero sales (after sufficient data)
- Search term indicates research intent, not purchase intent
- Search term is a competitor brand you do not want to target
- Search term is too broad and wasting spend

Types of Negative Keywords

- Exact Negative: Block the exact term only
- Phrase Negative: Block any search containing the phrase
- Tip: Start with exact negatives; phrase negatives can block too much traffic

Step-by-Step Process

1. Download search term report
2. Sort by spend (highest first)
3. For zero-sale terms with 15+ clicks: evaluate relevance
4. Add irrelevant terms as exact negatives
5. Document each negative addition in your changelog
6. Monitor for 3-5 days to confirm spend reduction
7. Review broad negatives weekly to avoid over-negating

Common Mistakes

- Negating too quickly (before sufficient data)
- Using phrase negatives when exact would suffice
- Not documenting negative additions (causes confusion later)
- Negating terms that could be seasonal performers
- Forgetting to check negative keyword lists for errors